AEP FROM ZERO • PART 2 • SPEAK TO YOUR CUSTOMER (AJO)

EPISODE 21

Abandoned Cart Journey in AJO, Step by Step

How do you build an abandoned cart journey in Adobe Journey Optimizer? In this AJO tutorial, Bloom builds Cart Rescue v1 step by step: an event-triggered journey that enters on the abandon event, a wait window chosen from Bloom's own data, and a cart abandonment email that renders the actual cart items from the event payload, with fallbacks and a dynamic subject line. You will set exit criteria so customers who purchase leave the journey, add a pre-send check and a re-entrance cap of once in

Previously: Welcome v1 goes live

- Last time: fallbacks first, and an if-else Gold line
- Conditional content, debugged by reading its code
- Relaunch Monday: Bloom Welcome v1 went live
- Today: Cart Rescue v1, the abandoned cart journey
- Rescue carts, let buyers go, prove the money

KEY IDEA

Bloom Welcome v1 went live on relaunch Monday. Now the team builds the journey that pays for the programme: Cart Rescue v1.

Every night, carts left behind

- Thousands of rupees left in carts every night
- Old habit: same email, twice a week, 20 percent off
- There is no cart object anywhere in the data
- A cart is add to cart, not followed by a purchase
- The rescue must land while she still wants it

KEY IDEA

Thousands of rupees of product sit in abandoned carts every night. There is no cart object: a cart is add to cart events with no purchase after them.

A fast trigger: the abandon event

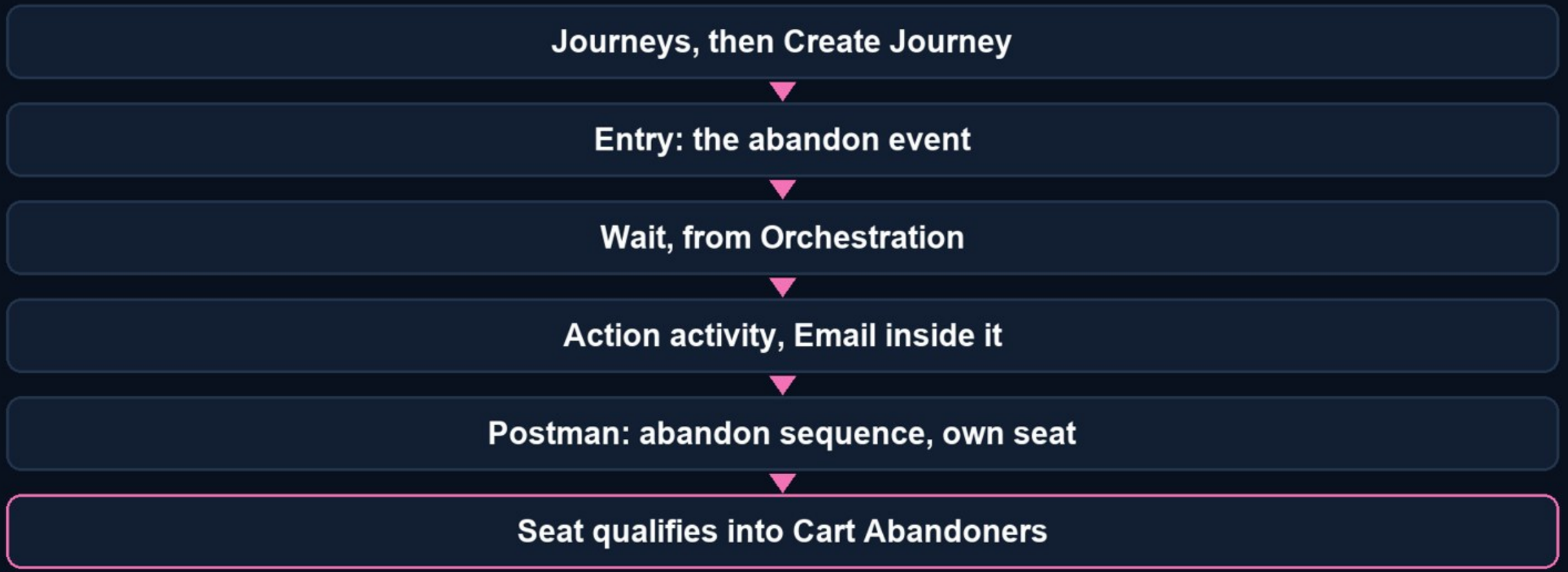
	Batch audience	Event entry
Reacts	Once every 24 hours	The moment it happens
Unit	Everyone, as a snapshot	One person at a time
Not followed by purchase	A clock inside the rule	A wait, then an exit
For cart rescue	Hours stale, intent cold	While intent is warm

Event set-up is admin work; Adobe documents the flow, so check your screen

KEY IDEA

Cart Rescue v1 enters on the abandon event, an event entry that admits one person the moment it happens. A daily batch audience arrives too late.

Drafting Cart Rescue v1, proving the door



KEY IDEA

Kavya drafts the entry, a Wait and one Action. Farhan's Postman abandon sequence shows a test seat qualifying into Cart Abandoners 24h.

How long to wait? Ask your own data

Wait before the email	What happens
A few minutes	Interrupts someone still shopping
One to four hours	The usual first-touch range
Around 24 hours	A typical second touch
Several days	The moment has passed

Bloom's first touch: four hours, chosen from its own add-to-cart gap

KEY IDEA

Too short interrupts a shopper; too long misses the moment. Most land at one to four hours. Bloom chose four, from its own data.

Show the real cart: the event payload

Read from	It tells you
Profile attributes	Who she is: name, tier, consent
The event payload	What was in the cart at that moment
Each item in the payload	Product name, image and price
A fallback for each field	What to show when a piece is missing

KEY IDEA

The email reads the cart from the triggering event's payload, not from profile attributes: the name, image and price of each item.

When the payload is missing a piece

If the event lacks	The email still shows
The product image	Name and price, with no broken box
The whole item list	You left something lovely in your cart
The first name	Hi there, the greeting fallback

KEY IDEA

Every field read from an event needs a fallback. A missing image must not leave a broken box, and a missing item list needs a line that works alone.

One subject line, two tones

Who	Tone	Example subject
Gold members	Early access	Your picks are saved for you
Everyone else	Gentle urgency	Your cart is still waiting

One if-else on the loyalty band under _bloom, a single equals sign

KEY IDEA

A dynamic subject gives Gold members an early-access tone and everyone else gentle urgency, written as an if-else on the loyalty band.

The step everyone forgets: Priya already bought

7:44 PM: serum added on her phone

▼

Sign-in links the app's ECID to email

▼

7:52 PM: order BLM-88412, laptop

▼

Exit on any purchase: she leaves

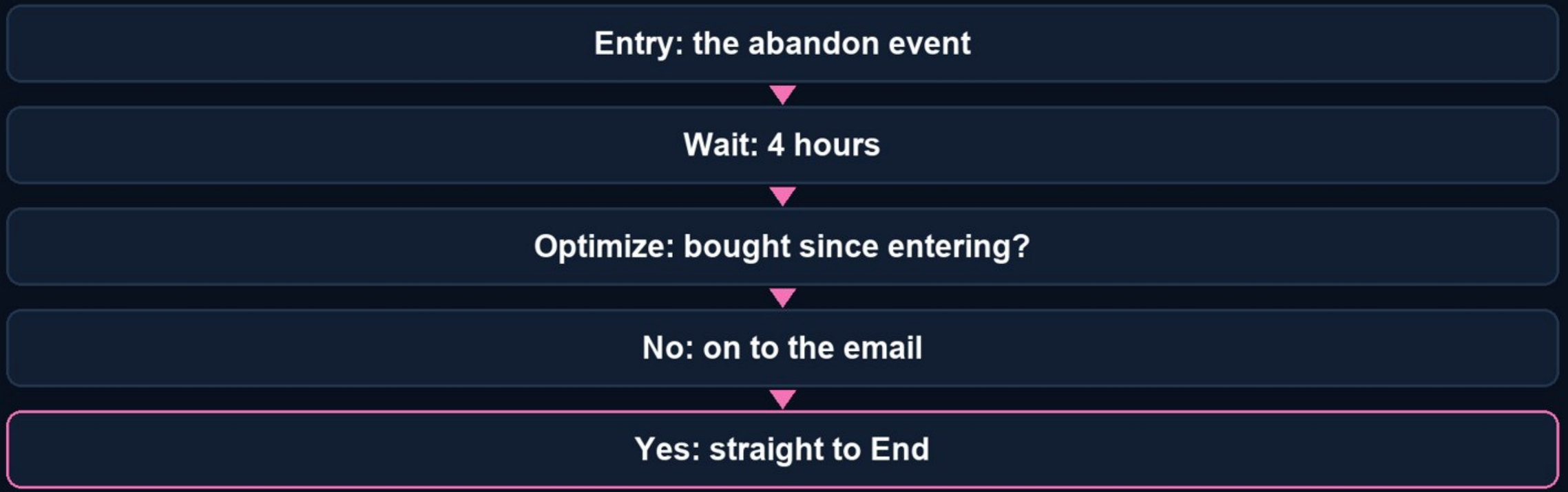
▼

11:44 PM: no rescue email is sent

KEY IDEA

Between the trigger and the send, some people buy. Exit criteria on any purchase remove them, so Priya leaves at 7:52 PM, eight minutes in.

A second lock: the pre-send check



KEY IDEA

Just before the email, an Optimize activity re-reads the current profile, not the state at entry. Exit criteria plus a pre-send check.

Re-entry: at most once in seven days

Journey property	Default	Cart Rescue v1
Allow reentrance	On	On
Reentrance wait period	5 minutes	7 days
What it means	A rescue on every abandon	At most once a week

KEY IDEA

Allow reentrance is on by default with a 5-minute wait period. Cart Rescue v1 sets it to 7 days, so nobody gets a rescue email every evening.

Proving the exit: Test mode, not Simulation

Test seat	Events fired	What arrived
TD-KAVYA-01, Gold	Abandon only	Early-access subject, cart
TD-ROHAN-04, Silver	Abandon, image removed	Hi there, no broken image
TD-FARHAN-02, Silver	Abandon, then purchase	Nothing: he exited

Adobe documents the event flow this way; check what your screen shows

KEY IDEA

Simulation does not support exit criteria, so the purchase exit is proven in Test mode on the team's own seats, with waits cut to 10 seconds.

Rohan's question: was it the email?

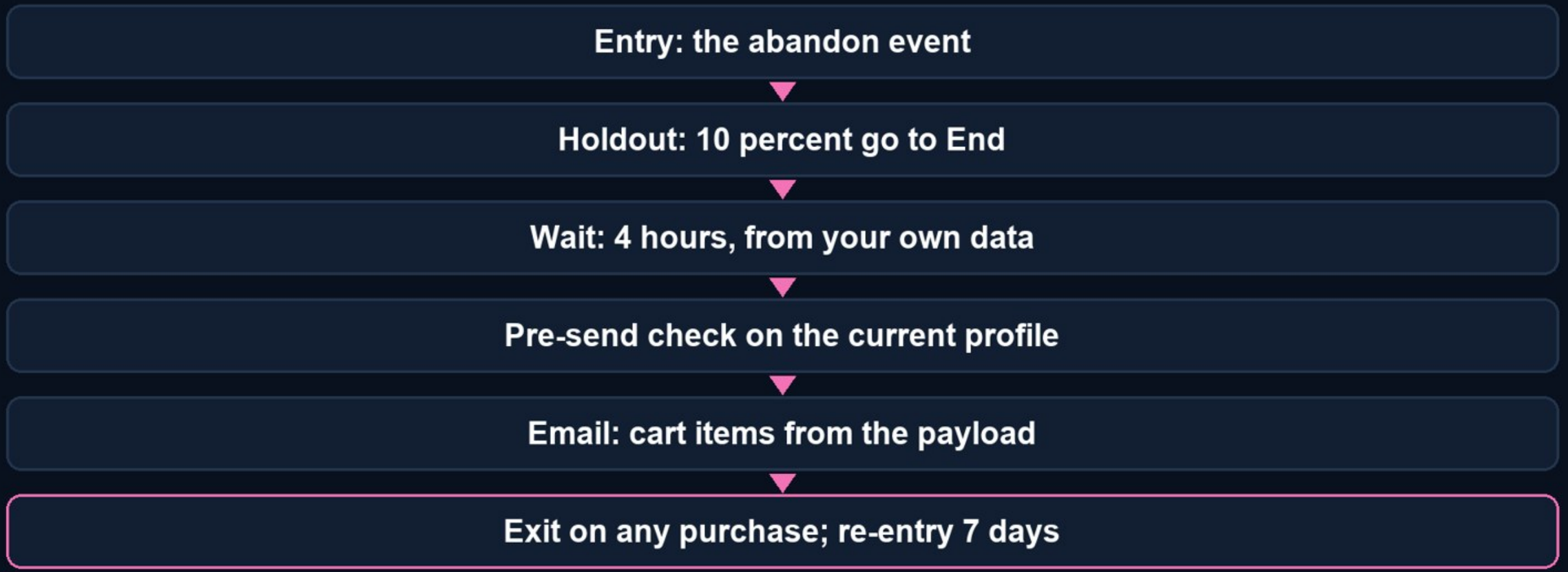
	Attributed revenue	Incremental revenue
Counts	Buyers who got the email	Extra buyers it caused
Includes Priya-like buyers	Yes	No
Needs	Just a report	A holdout, from day one

Cart Rescue v1 holds back a random 10 percent

KEY IDEA

Attributed revenue counts buyers who would have bought anyway. A random holdout, set on day one, measures what the journey truly caused.

Cart Rescue v1, start to finish



KEY IDEA

An abandoned cart journey in seven parts: event entry, holdout, wait, pre-send check, email from the payload, exit on purchase, re-entry cap.

Interview corner

- Attributed revenue is not incremental revenue
- Set a holdout on day one
- Proof: Cart Rescue v1 holds back 10 percent
- Then: exit on purchase, plus a pre-send check

KEY IDEA

Attributed revenue is not incremental revenue. Set a holdout on day one.

Recap, your question, and the discount habit

- Enter on the event, while intent is warm
- Wait window from your own data: four hours
- Cart items from the event payload, with fallbacks
- Exit on purchase, pre-send check, re-entry 7 days
- Next: offers and decisioning

KEY IDEA

Fast trigger, data-chosen wait, the real cart, buyers out, a holdout from day one. Next: offers and decisioning to end the 20 percent habit.